



The QPPV: who holds the line on drug safety in the EU

A clear guide to the Qualified Person Responsible for Pharmacovigilance, and why one named individual carries so much weight.

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What is a QPPV?

The Qualified Person Responsible for Pharmacovigilance is the named individual that a Marketing Authorisation Holder (MAH) must appoint to establish and maintain its pharmacovigilance system across the EEA.

- Personally responsible for the safety profile of every authorised product.
- Must be continuously available, around the clock.



Where the rules come from

Directive 2001/83/EC

Article 104: the core obligation to appoint a QPPV

Regulation (EC) No 726/2004

Pharmacovigilance duties for centrally authorised products

Directive 2010/84/EU and Reg. (EU) No 1235/2010

The 2012 EU pharmacovigilance reforms, now consolidated into the texts above

Implementing Reg. (EU) No 520/2012

Minimum requirements for the QPPV, expanded in EMA GVP Module I



Where must the QPPV reside?

- Must reside and operate in the [EU/EEA](#).
- Can be a direct employee or a contractor, as long as they stay continuously at the MAH's disposal.
- The UK needs its own arrangement: a UK QPPV, or a UK LPPV where the QPPV sits outside the UK.



What the QPPV oversees

- Establishing and maintaining the PV system and its quality system.
- Full oversight of product safety profiles and any emerging concerns.
- Signal detection activities and Risk Management Plans (RMPs).



One point of contact for the authorities

- Acts as the single contact for regulators, available 24/7.
- Ensures complete, accurate, and timely responses to safety requests.
- Holds the authority to influence the quality system and PV activities.



The Master File connection

The Pharmacovigilance System Master File (PSMF) describes how the whole system works.

- The QPPV keeps the PSMF current and accurate.
- Authorities can request it at any time.



Delegate tasks, keep the accountability

- Specific tasks can go to trained, qualified staff.
- Overall oversight and accountability stay with the QPPV.
- Many MAHs nominate a back-up person to cover the QPPV's absences.

IN SHORT



The QPPV is not a title on an org chart.

It is the person who answers for patient safety,
every day, to every regulator across the EEA.

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